5. Long blackout, cold and sheltering at home (English)

Oracle OS guide (FEMA, Ready Scotland, NHS, Nordic guides).

First hours checklist

Torch (avoid candles), check elderly/ill neighbours; unplug sensitive devices, leave one light on; keep fridge/freezer **closed**; fill containers while there is water pressure; turn on the radio; save phone battery (airplane mode, check at set times); keep cold-chain medicines in a cool box with ice (in-use insulin usually keeps weeks at room temperature — check the leaflet); have a plan for home medical equipment.

Staying warm without heating

- Everyone in **one small inner room**, other doors closed; cover windows with blankets/cardboard/plastic; block draughts with rolled towels.
- **Layers** of loose clothing, hat, wool socks, gloves; keep clothes **dry**.
- Sleep insulated from the floor; a blanket "tent" over the bed traps heat.
- Eat and drink warm drinks; **avoid alcohol**. Sealed hot-water bottles wrapped in cloth.
- **Never** heat the home with a gas cooker, oven, grill or generator (carbon monoxide).

Hypothermia

Signs: violent shivering, numb hands, slurred speech, confusion, drowsiness, clumsiness; babies: bright red cold skin, very low energy. Warm place, remove wet clothes, warm the **core first** (chest, neck, head, groin) with blankets or skin-to-skin; warm drinks **only if fully conscious**; don't rub the skin; call 112/999/911. Frostbite: rewarm in warm (not hot) water, don't rub, don't refreeze.

Extreme heat

Coolest room, shutters closed by day, open at night, drink regularly, wet the skin, avoid exertion; heatstroke (confusion, hot dry skin, collapse): cool immediately and call for help.

Generator

Outdoors only, at least 6 m from doors and windows; never back-feed the house wiring without a transfer switch.